

WORD PROCESSOR (MS WORD)

This is an Application software package that enables the user to type, edit, format, store, retrieve and print mainly text-based document. Put in another way, this package turns an electronic computer into an electronic typing machine. Examples of Word processors include:

- Ms Word
- MultiMate
- AmiPro
- Word Perfect
- Note pad
- Word star
- Letter Perfect

CONCEPTS OF WORD PROCESSING

Word processing is the activities of typing, editing, formatting, storing, retrieving and printing. Mainly text-based document with computer *Software*

What is an Operating System?

The operating system is a special type of program that loads automatically when you start your computer. The operating system allows you to use the advanced features of a modern computer without having to learn all the details of how the hardware works. There are a number of different types of operating system in common use. The IBM PC (Personal Computer) was introduced way back in 1981 and was originally supplied with an operating system called DOS (Disk Operating System). This operating system was very basic, and you had to be a bit of a computer expert just to understand how to use it. It was NOT user-friendly. Later on, Microsoft introduced Windows and this is the operating system that is most widely used on PCs today. To complicate matters further, there are a number of different types of Windows. The first widely used version of Windows was called Windows 3.1. This was more powerful than DOS and far easier to use. It had a Graphical User Interface (GUI), i.e. you could 'drive' it using a mouse and drop down menus.

Main functions of an operating system

- Security: protection of data files and programs from unauthorized use;
- Accounting: accounting and logging of the use of the computer resources.
- Program Loading to the main memory for processing
- Multiprogramming
- Interrupt handling
- Job Sequencing
- File Management
- Job Scheduling
- Peripheral Control
- Recovery from System Failure

What is a Graphical User Interface?

A Graphical User Interface (GUI) is simply an additional part of the operating system that displays windows and drop down menus, and also enables you to drive your computer using a mouse. Examples of operating system that use a GUI include Windows and IBM's OS/2.

The advantages of using a GUI

- All programs look similar and when you switch from a program supplied by one manufacturer to one from a different manufacturer, you will find the transition very easy.
- Application programs work in the same way as the underlying operating system.
- The GUI also allows programmers to easily write consistent looking programs.

What is an application program?

An application program is the type of program that you use once the operating system has been loaded. Examples include word-processing programs (for producing letters, memos etc), spreadsheets (for doing accounts and working with numbers), databases (for organizing large amounts of information) and graphics programs (for producing pictures, advertisements, manuals etc).

- **Word processing:** A word processing program (such as Microsoft Word) allows you to easily produce letters, memos, etc. You can easily mail merge a list of names and addresses to produce mass mailers, individually addressed to customers or subscribers.
- **Spreadsheets:** A spreadsheet program (such as Microsoft Excel) allows you to work out a company's income, expenditure and then calculate the balance. It enables you to make what if type projections of how the company will fair in the future and to forecast how changes in prices will affect profits.
- **Databases:** A database program (such as Microsoft Access) allows you to compile information and then to search this information to extract just the information you require. For instance, if you have a database of all the equipment housed within an office you can very simply produce a report listing only the equipment above a certain value.
- **Presentation:** A presentation program (such as Microsoft PowerPoint) allows you to produce professional looking presentations, which can be printed out directly onto slides for use with an overhead projector. Alternatively, you can display your presentations directly on a computer screen.
- **Web browsing:** These applications allow you to view and interact with the World Wide Web (WWW).
- **Web authoring:** These applications allow almost anyone to create a web site, quickly and easily.

Advantages of Word processing

- **Spell check:** If you type anything with wrong spelling or grammar mistakes then an underline will show up under the word. You can right-click on that word and then choose the right word.
- **Print-ready:** Before printing a document, you can check the document how it is seen after the print. You can make as many changes in the document before print.
- **Multiple people:** If you want to allow another person to do future changes to the document then you can mark up the text and the other person can make changes to the document easily.

- **Templates:** There are many ready-made templates that you can use to create startup documents. The templates have preformatted placeholders that you can use to insert your content.
- **Fast search:** You can search in the document easily and it is fast. You can also replace any word in the document and it is fast also.
- **Quick access bar:** You have the option to add/remove items from the quick access toolbar. This toolbar helps in your tasks while you are typing. You can bold, make italic, and change font type, change font size and many other options.
- **Typing fast:** If you have an idea of what to type then you can make the document ready by typing fast. Your typing speed also increases if you type regularly in MS Word.
- **Convert to pdf:** When you finish editing the document then you can convert the document to pdf file. This is a very handy feature of MS Word.
- **User friendly:**

Disadvantages of Word processing

- **Complexity:** If you are a newcomer then you will feel trouble understanding the features of MS Word. There are hundreds of options and you may not use most of the options while working in the document.
- **Plagiarism:** You can copy and paste any copyrighted text in the document and there is no restriction on this. So the chance of creating duplicated content is high.
- **Using ribbon:** The ribbon is the top menu in the toolbar. It is used to categorize different options in the document. Most people feel difficulty in using ribbon because there are many options in easy ribbon and most of the features are not used by a normal user.